

music festivals

Tonal Fiesta

DELHI Rains after summer are welcome in more ways than one. Apart from the much-needed respite from the scorching sun, the gentle pitter-patter of rain-drops accompanied by thunder and lightning makes for music in its most elemental form. This magic of the monsoons has been much written about and a theme for many a song, including the well-known song *Rimjhim gire saawan* from the movie *Manzil* or the raga *Miya ki Malhar*.

Come August 11, Delhi-ites can experience the spirit of monsoon at a three-day festival organised by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations to be held at the Kamani Auditorium. It opens with Pandit Amarnath on the flute, who will be followed by a kathak dance performance by Monisa Nayak, a disciple of Rajendra Gangani. Scheduled for the second day is T. H. Vikku Vinayakram's car-natic music percussion ensemble. He is a rage on stage, especially when he flings the ghatam from his

torso into the air and catches it in perfect timing with his taal. The spirit of semi-classical music will come alive with Kumud Diwan's thumris and kajris in Purab Ang style. The last day will have Ustad Eltaf Hussain Sarang from Afghanistan staging a vocal performance. He belongs to the Patiala gharana. The finale is a celebration of Rajasthan's folk tradition by Kohinoor Langa & Party.

Another festival which should not be missed is the Pandit Ganpat Rao Memorial Music Festival at Habitat World from August 12 to 14. Very few know that Ganpat Rao was an accomplished classical harmonium player from the Gwalior gharana. The festival begins with vocal performances by Ojesh Pratap Singh and Ritesh and Rajneesh Mishra. The second day will see Abdul Mazed Khan and Fakrudin Dhaulpuri striking a harmony on the sarangi. This will be followed by a vocal recital by Pandit Bholanath Mishra. Reserve the last day for a rare recital of ragas on the harmonium by Pandit Mohan Moongrey.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

SONG AND DANCE: Ojesh (left) and Monisa Nayak



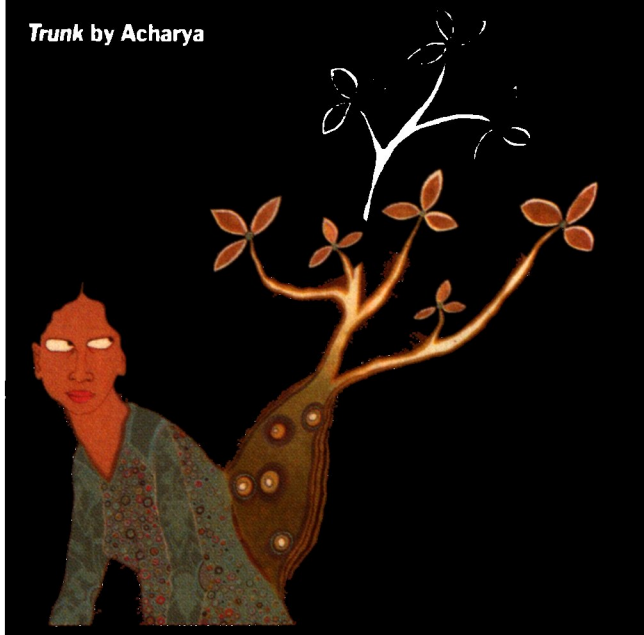
art exhibition

Heart of Nature

MUMBAI Envision a world devoid of clean air, where women grow their oxygen and violence spills onto the streets. *One Life on Earth* is a collection of work which procures images of possibilities engendering thought. In this series of 40 acrylics and 50 watercolours, Dhruvi Acharya deals with contemporary issues like air pollution, violence and gender inequality. Her work is influenced by her concern for the environment. She combines paradigms of advertising, graphics, typography, Indian miniatures, comic books and contemporary street art. "The paintings are based on my drawing books which are a chronicle of my thoughts, emotions and experiences," says Acharya. This exhibition is different from Acharya's previous work and is immense in scale and opaque. At Chemould Prescott Road. On till August 30.

by Neha Thirani

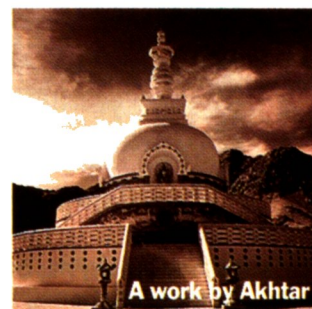
Trunk by Acharya



exhibition

Wheels to Heaven

DELHI Photographer and civil servant Shamim Akhtar travelled to Ladakh on his motorbike and captured its beauty and treacherous roads through his lens. The exhibition, *Rode to Heaven*—a biker's solo trip to Ladakh in 16 days, is his attempt to weave the pictures in the form of a narrative. He has



A work by Akhtar

used infrared photography without resorting to any digital manipulation. At the India Habitat Centre, from August 11 to 17.